What the RSS Wants in Education

On the Narad Index, the Sangh's emphasis on education is way higher than mentions of education by the BJP or in Prime Minister Modi's communications outreach (see Figure 14.7). The RSS primarily has four broad concerns on education: reviving indigenous education practices, wresting control of the historical narrative on the Indian past from what it sees as a dominant Leftist perspective, reviving Indian language education and reversing what it thinks of as a colonial-minded education inherited from the British (driven by those it derisively refers to as 'Macaulay-putras', or the sons of Macaulay). Lord Macaulay's 1835 'Minute on Education' had set the template for British policies to impart English education to the 'natives' in British India. In the view of Hindu nationalists, independent India had continued to let its education policies be defined by the metaphorical 'sons of Macaulay' who, they believe, scorned local languages, indigenous forms of knowledge and Hindu-nationalist narratives. These beliefs, and the need to reverse the situation as the RSS sees it, form the basis of all Sangh Parivar education initiatives.

Figure 14.7: RSS Focuses More on Education than BJP: Second Highest Priority after Hindutva